

Data Validation in **Excel** is a feature that allows you to control the type of data or values that users enter into a cell.

It helps ensure that the data entered in your worksheet is accurate, consistent, and within the limits you define.

Why we use Data Validation in Excel

1. **Prevent wrong data entry**

- For example, you can allow only whole numbers between 1 and 100.
- This stops users from entering text or numbers outside the range.

2. **Maintain consistency**

- You can restrict entries to a predefined list (e.g., "Male, Female, Other"), ensuring uniform values.

3. **Reduce errors in reports and analysis**

- By restricting input, the chances of incorrect data affecting calculations, charts, and pivot tables are minimized.

4. **Save time in data cleaning**

- With controlled inputs, you won't need to spend extra time fixing invalid entries later.

5. **Improve user guidance**

- You can show input messages to guide users about what type of data to enter.
 - You can also display error alerts if invalid data is entered.
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Common Uses of Data Validation

- Restrict input to **whole numbers, decimals, dates, or text length**.
 - Create a **drop-down list** for selecting predefined options.
 - Allow only values that meet a **custom formula condition**.
 - Prevent duplicate entries in a column.
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Example:

If you have a column for "Employee Age," you can set data validation to only allow numbers between 18 and 60.

If someone tries to type "70" or "Text," Excel will show an error message.